

- Review your bank statements monthly and immediately report discrepancies.
- If you notice suspicious transactions, block your card or account access temporarily until further investigation.



7. Do not trust financial offers that require upfront payments

Many scams involve fraudulent schemes that require upfront payments, such as fake investment platforms, loan scams, or Ponzi schemes.

How to protect yourself:

- Avoid investment schemes that promise guaranteed high returns with no risk.
- Be skeptical of platforms that demand an advance fee before offering financial services.
- Check if the platform has a verified history of processing withdrawals and fulfilling promises.

8. Check regulatory approvals before investing in crypto or financial products

Many fraudulent investment schemes claim to be registered but operate without regulatory approvals. Before investing in any financial product, confirm its legitimacy with the appropriate governing body.

How to protect yourself:

- Verify the registration status of investment firms with authorities like the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) or the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
- For cryptocurrency platforms, check if they are recognized by reputable financial regulators such as Financial Conduct Authority (FCA), U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC), or Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS).
- Avoid platforms that claim to operate outside regulatory oversight to evade compliance.

9. Report fraudulent messages, websites, and accounts immediately

Timely reporting of scams can prevent others from falling

victim and increase the chances of taking legal action against fraudsters.

How to protect yourself:

- Report suspicious websites to CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) and cybercrime.gov.in.
- If you receive scam messages or calls, report them to your bank's fraud department and local cyber police.
- Use fraud reporting tools in social media platforms to flag scam advertisements and fake accounts.

10. Stay updated on latest scam tactics through credible news Sources

Scammers continuously adapt their techniques, making it crucial to stay informed about emerging fraud trends.

How to protect yourself:

- Follow fintech security updates from official sources such as RBI, SEBI, CERT-In, and major cybersecurity firms.
- Subscribe to newsletters or alerts from reputed news agencies covering fintech scams.
- Join online forums like r/Scams on Reddit or follow crypto and fintech security blogs to learn from real-world scam cases.

Final thoughts

The digital finance landscape is rapidly evolving, and while it brings convenience, it also exposes users to new forms of financial fraud. Protecting yourself from fintech scams requires



vigilance, education, and adopting robust security measures. By following these tips, you can significantly reduce the risk of financial fraud and safeguard your hard-earned money. Remember, if an opportunity sounds too good to be true, it probably is. Stay cautious, verify sources, and take proactive steps to secure your financial future. **d**